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THE MODERN, EMPOWERED Indian woman is not whispering her needs anymore. She is owning her voice, and her health. Fuelled by increasing awareness, greater access to information, and a growing demand for autonomy over her well-being, she is transforming the healthcare landscape. In response, the Indian pharmaceutical sector is stepping up.

From addressing the everyday realities of menstrual pain and the crucial stages of prenatal care to tackling hormonal balance and supporting fitness nutrition, drugmakers are reimagining their consumer health portfolios with a clear focus on convenience, personalisation and preventive care, meeting women where they are, with solutions that can seamlessly integrate into their lives.

PHARMA'S RX: WOMEN FIRST

Recognising the potential, major pharmaceutical players like Dr. Reddy's Laboratories, Bayer, and Mankind Pharma are expanding their portfolios to cater to the diverse health and wellness needs of women at various life stages.

Dr. Reddy's Laboratories, in a strategic collaboration with Nestlé India, is aiming to capture a significant share of this market by offering a range of nutritional health products. The brands from Nestlé Health Science include Nature's Bounty,

Osteo Bi-Flex, Ester-C, Resource High Protein, Optifast, Resource Diabetic, Pep-tamen, Resource Renal, and Resource Dialysis. Dr. Reddy's will contribute brands such as Rebalanz, Celevida, Antoxid, Kidrich-D3, and Becozinc in nutrition and over-the-counter (OTC) segments. This expansion is further evidenced by their acquisition of brands like Premama, targeting fertility, and MenoLabs, addressing the needs of menopausal women, alongside a well-established presence in OTC products across various international markets, with a specific emphasis on women's health, allergy relief, and pain management.

Meanwhile, Bayer's Consumer Health Division addressed a significant and often overlooked need in India with the launch of Saridon Woman in 2024. Sandeep Verma, Cluster Head—South Asia, Bayer Consumer Health, emphasises that "Saridon Woman is specifically designed to ease menstrual pain."

Mankind Pharma is also strategically extending its reach within the women's health segment, offering a diverse range of products spanning reproductive care, personal wellness, dermatology, and fitness. Joy Chatterjee, Vice President and Sales and Marketing Head of Mankind Pharma's Consumer Business Unit, highlights their core philosophy. "Our focus is on creating solutions that empower women to take charge of their health, with an emphasis on accessibility and preventive care."

A key example of this is Prega News, a home pregnancy detection kit. It has also broadened offerings to include ovulation kits, fertility supplements, prenatal vitamins, and stretch mark prevention products, supporting healthy pregnancies. Furthermore, they offer Unwanted-21, a readily available contraceptive pill, and Acnestar, a skincare solution targeting

